

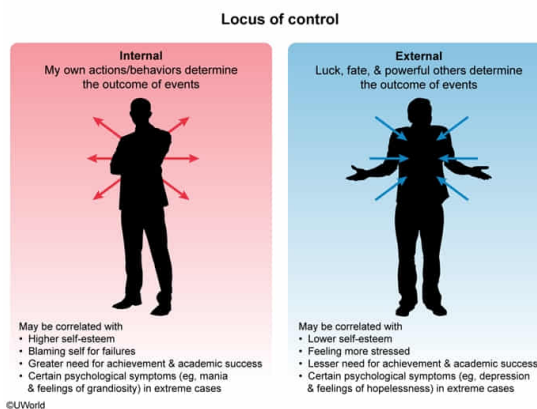
A researcher hypothesizes that there is a positive correlation between symptom severity of post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD) and external locus of control. Which hypothetical finding would support this hypothesis?

- ☐ A. A more distorted and unstable self-image is associated with a stronger belief that the outcomes of events are controlled by one's own actions. [1%]
- ☐ B. A more distorted and unstable self-image is associated with a stronger belief that the outcomes of events are due to luck, fate, or powerful others. [16%]
- ☐ C. More severe hyperarousal is associated with a stronger belief that the outcomes of events are controlled by one's own actions. [3%]
- ✔ ☒ D. More severe hyperarousal is associated with a stronger belief that the outcomes of events are due to luck, fate, or powerful others. [77%]

Correct

77% answered correctly

Explanation:



Locus of control (LOC) refers to an individual's beliefs about who or what **controls the outcome** of an event or situation. Individuals with an **external LOC** feel that outcomes are due to factors **beyond their control**, such as luck, fate, or powerful others. Individuals with an **internal LOC** feel that outcomes are due to factors **within their control**, such as their own behaviors.

Post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD) is a trauma- and stressor-related disorder that can arise after **exposure to trauma**, an event that resulted or almost resulted in death or serious injury (eg, assault). A PTSD diagnosis requires evidence of several types of symptoms, including hyperarousal (eg, exaggerated startle response, insomnia); intrusive symptoms (eg, nightmares, flashbacks); avoiding reminders of the trauma; and negative thoughts and moods.

The researcher's hypothesis would be supported by the finding that more severe hyperarousal (a symptom of PTSD) is associated with a stronger belief that the outcomes of events are due to luck, fate, or powerful others (external LOC).

(Choices A, B, and C) A distorted and unstable self-image (ie, view of oneself) is characteristic of borderline personality disorder, not PTSD. The belief that the outcomes of

events are controlled by one's own actions refers to an *internal* (not external) LOC.

Educational objective:

Locus of control (LOC) refers to an individual's beliefs about who or what controls the outcome of a situation: Either a person has the ability to influence outcomes of events (internal LOC), or outcomes are determined by luck, fate, or powerful others (external LOC). Post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD) can arise after exposure to a traumatic event and is characterized by hyperarousal, intrusive symptoms, avoidance behaviors, and negative thoughts/mood.

Time spent:0 sec

Subject:

Behavioral Sciences

QID:401300

System:

Motivation, Emotion, Attitudes, Personality, and Stress